

son's computing usage involve? Nothing more than Facebook, a bit of YouTube, some instagraming and maybe a bit of mild video editing. Most work is also something that just involves office suites and e-mails. You don't need a quad-core i7 to do that. In fact, you don't even need an i3. An ARM-based tablet or phone can do that much admirably while still giving you portability and stellar battery life. Nowadays building your own computer is almost considered to be the equivalent of building your own table or chair. Computing is such an integral part of our lives that it has just been taken for granted. You might think that this only applies to first world countries but you'd be wrong. More people have smartphones than PCs and internet access is just a SIM card away. Almost everyone knows how to operate a phone, send an email and browse the web. Where is Windows or Intel here? They just don't matter anymore. Internet Explorer 6 was the most popular browser for so long, despite being so flawed and people still used it and not just because they didn't know any better. They didn't know any better but it was more the fact that the prospect of using a PC (and Windows) was such a daunting task that they just preferred to stick to something they knew rather than try something new which might create a whole pile of other unknown issues.

It is this situation that Apple managed to take advantage of when it launched the iPad. People were comfortable with it, they never really felt that they could damage the OS. They got a good device, a good browser, it could access the internet and it seemed way better than the Windows experience that they had been used to for so long. There was no more messing around with settings, no installing scary applications that might install a "virus". Curated content and a curated experience became the norm and it was enough. The geeks did fret and fume about it, but Google lent a hand and Android filled the gap.

Microsoft (and intel), for whatever reason, remained completely oblivious to this space and while they did ultimately

catch on, they were far too late. The products they released just seemed slapped together and while they had the right idea, they were too late and tried too hard to adapt in too short a time period.

A gamer's rant

As far as gaming is concerned there has been a marked shift towards consoles and tablets with PC support being added only as an afterthought. How many big name titles have you seen for the PC that have been specifically developed for it? Granted, there are games that bring even the most powerful of systems to their knees, but they are few and far between and who, other than a few enthusiasts, has the money and patience to keep up with the upgrade race that defined the PC gaming experience? Console graphics are, well, abysmal when you compare them to that of a half-decent PC but so what? When most kids these days haven't experienced PC gaming on anything more powerful than a "gaming" laptop, and a PS3 (RISC architecture power's this beast) is the ultimate in graphics they've seen, they won't know any better. Ignorance is bliss. It isn't just ignorance though. When you take a console you are assured a consistent experience, assuredly sub-par in terms of graphics, but consistent nonetheless. It is easier for developers to code for such platforms and when the hardware

powerful, a little over two years old and already obsolete because it doesn't support DirectX 11.1. This monopolistic control of the entire market by Microsoft was not appreciated by developers or hardware makers, but since Wintel "ruled the roost" they had no option but to comply. It was a race to keep up and it was harsh. Everyone couldn't keep up and there were many that got left behind, and they jumped on to the easier alternative.

The monster in your room

People no longer want power-hungry "monstrosities" cluttering up their house. Few people have the time to maintain them. The face of the PC has changed. It is smaller, more efficient and is idiot-proof and hence, intelligently designed.

Take the current tablets for example, everyone has (or wants) one, they're powerful enough to give you console-level graphics, can output video to a TV wirelessly, let you browse the internet, check your mail, are sleek and portable, give you 10+ hour battery life, support basic photo and video editing; they are the new PC. It won't be long before your workstation becomes nothing more than a large monitor with attached keyboard and mouse and using your tablet or phone working as a thin-client of sorts (Ubuntu mobile for example).

As geeks we would (and do) find

this state of affairs to be very sad, but to an average person, things are looking up. The PC is no longer the domain of the geek, there are no complicated settings and everything just works. The devices don't need instruction manuals and even a child can set them up and use them. The power and flexibility of Wintel is currently



The future is mobile

is fixed, so is the game engine; translating into more time that can be spent in creating a better game.

The problem Wintel creates is that of an ever-changing standard (DirectX) that game developers and hardware manufacturers alike have to meet. Take the GTX290 for example, extremely

unrivalled, but nobody needs it anymore. The Windows OS is currently too heavy to run on low-end PCs and Intel doesn't have the efficiency to compete with ARM. Windows RT and the intel Atom are a step in the right direction but it is a step too small. Windows RT isn't yet fully optimized, has no apps and